



CESAB
CENTRE DE SYNTHÈSE ET D'ANALYSE
SUR LA BIODIVERSITÉ

INTRODUCTION AUX MÉTA-ANALYSES ET REVUES SYSTÉMATIQUES

Engaging stakeholders in environmental systematic reviews: benefits, challenges, and lessons learned

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Revue systématique et synthèses »

SOUTIENS INSTITUTIONNELS



Plan

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Outlining the
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environmental
evidence synthesis

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A framework for
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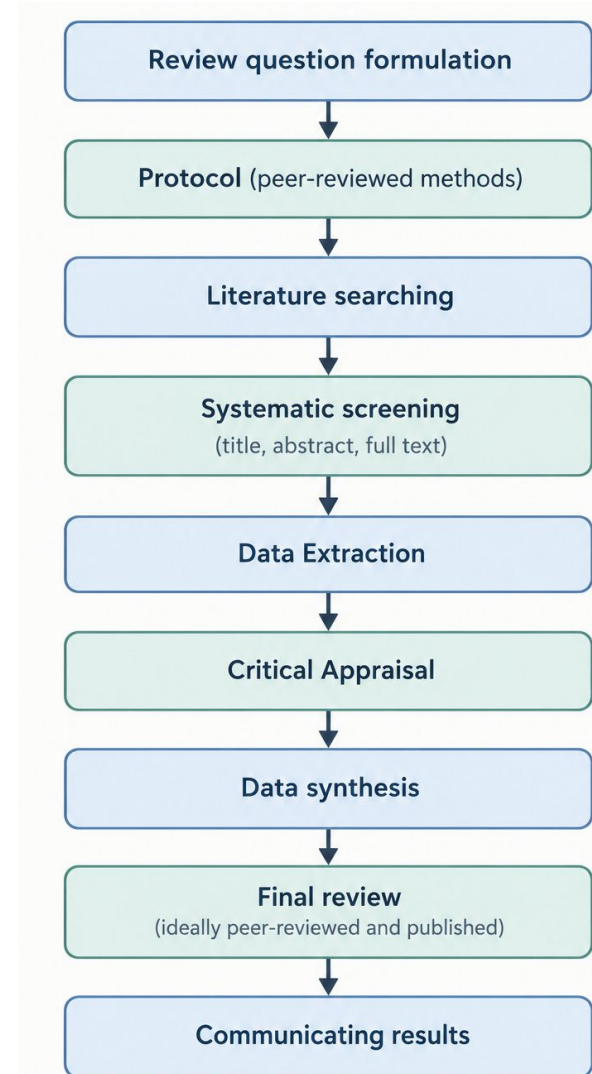
Challenges and
solutions

Where/when to engage stakeholders?

Most importantly – at the beginning of the process!



... but they can be involved at various other stages, depending on time and resources.



Defining groups and roles

- **The Review Team** – the group that conducts the review; the authors of the review.
- **The Stakeholder Group** – all individuals and organisations that might have a stake in the outcome of the review.

The Review Team

The group that conducts the review; the authors of the review report.



TYPICALLY INCLUDES

- Review lead / project manager
- Subject matter experts
- Data analysts / researchers
- Authors of the review report

The Stakeholder Group

All individuals and organisations that might have a stake in the outcome of the review (including the users...).



TYPICALLY INCLUDES

- Service users / end users
- Policy makers and regulators
- Organisations and partners
- Practitioners and professionals
- Community members / the public
- Other relevant groups

Source: Haddaway *et al.* 2017. *Environ Evid.* <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13750-017-0089-8>



Defining groups and roles

What is a stakeholder?

« Any group or individual who is affected by or can affect the achievement of an organisation's objectives » (Freeman, 1984)

Definition(s)

The client. The commissioner.

People who are either affected by the issue or those who may be able to influence the issue :
NGOs, Local authorities, governments.

Anyone with an interest in the particular subject, or anyone likely to be affected by an eventual decision.

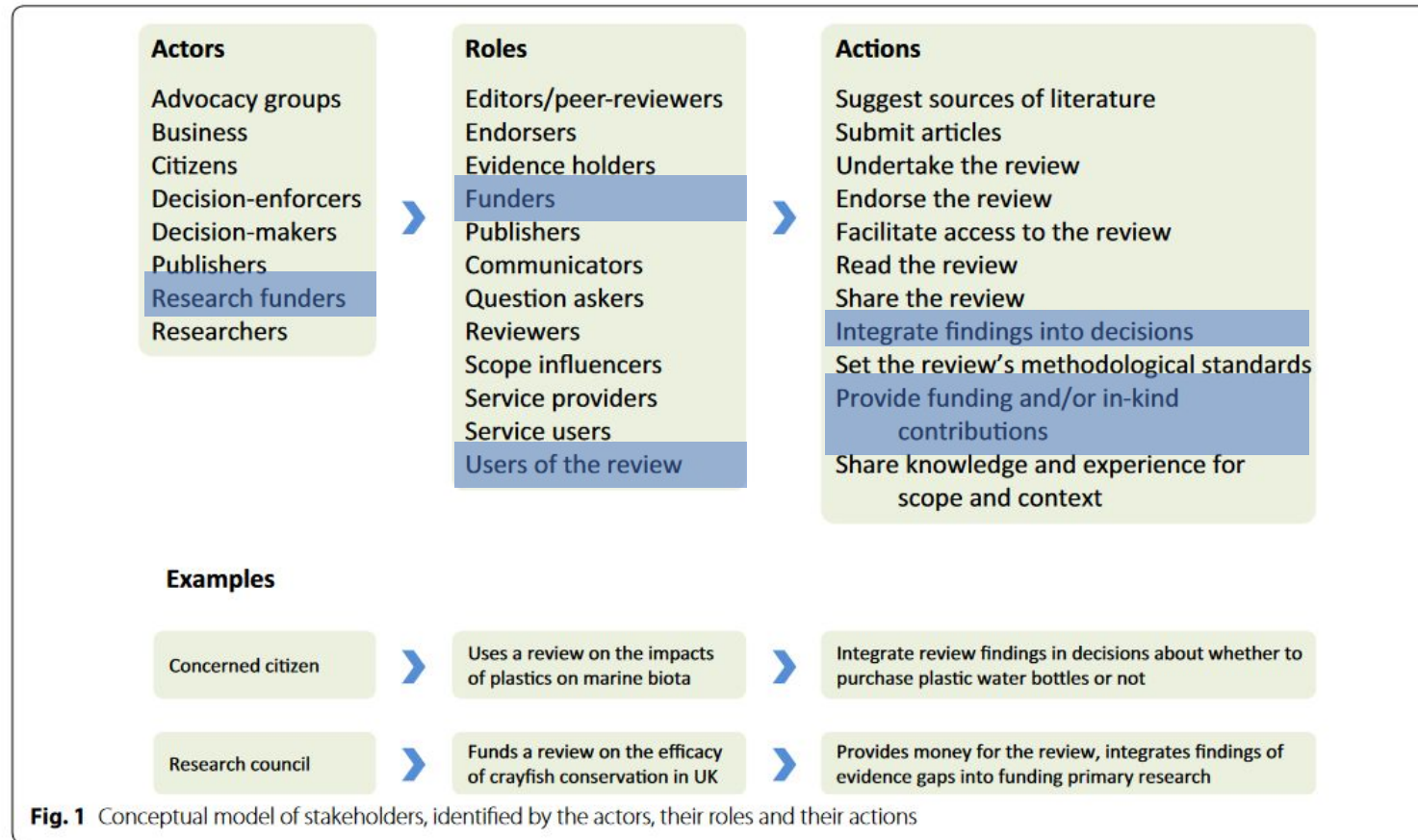
Those that have a **stake** in the question e.g. policy-makers, academics, educators, NGOs...

....

Source: Haddaway *et al.* 2017. *Environ Evid.* <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13750-017-0089-8>

Defining groups and roles

Stakeholders' roles and actions





Outlining the benefits

- Stakeholder engagement may provide several key benefits to environmental management research projects:
 - **Improving the evidence base** (Reed, 2008. *Biological Conservation*)
 - **Greater public acceptance** (Haddaway et al., 2017. *Environmental Evidence*)
 - **Higher likelihood of success** (Dougill et al., 2006. *Journal of Agricultural Economics*)
 - **Wider communication of findings** (Reed and Dougill, 2009. *Journal of Arid Environments*)
 - **Increased likelihood of impact on decision-making** (Haddaway et al., 2017. *Environmental Evidence*)

Outlining the benefits



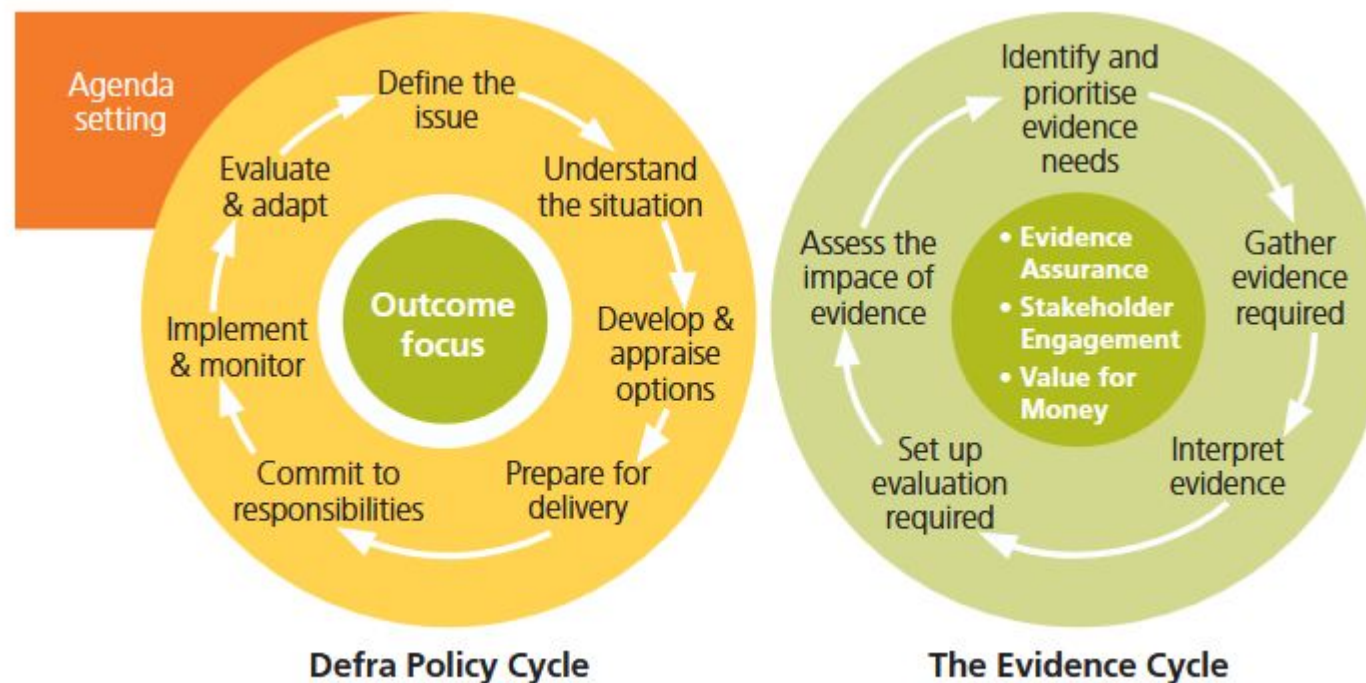
green arrows benefit the review,
orange arrows benefit the
stakeholders

**A mutually beneficial
process**

Source: Haddaway *et al.* 2017. *Environ Evid.* <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13750-017-0089-8>

Lessons from engaging stakeholders in environmental evidence synthesis

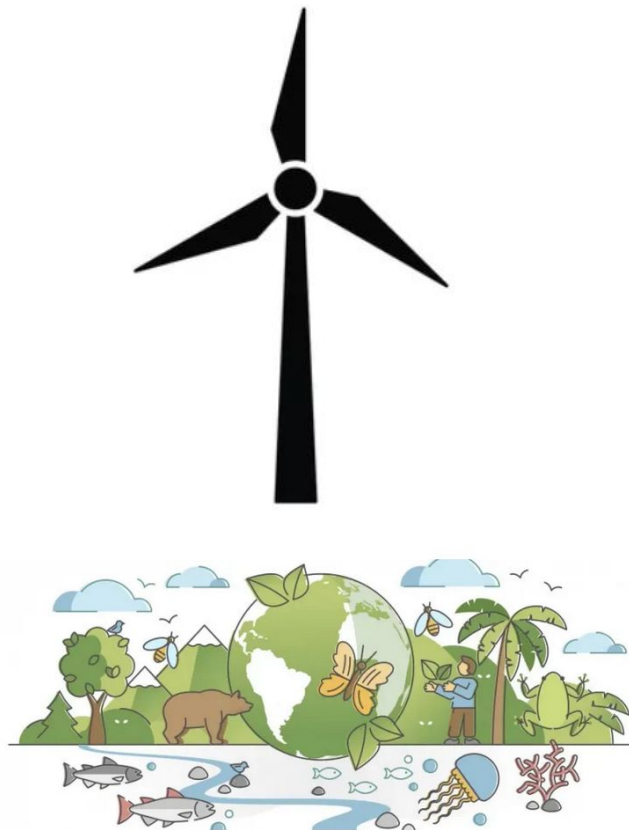
Adapting evidence cycles to policy cycles



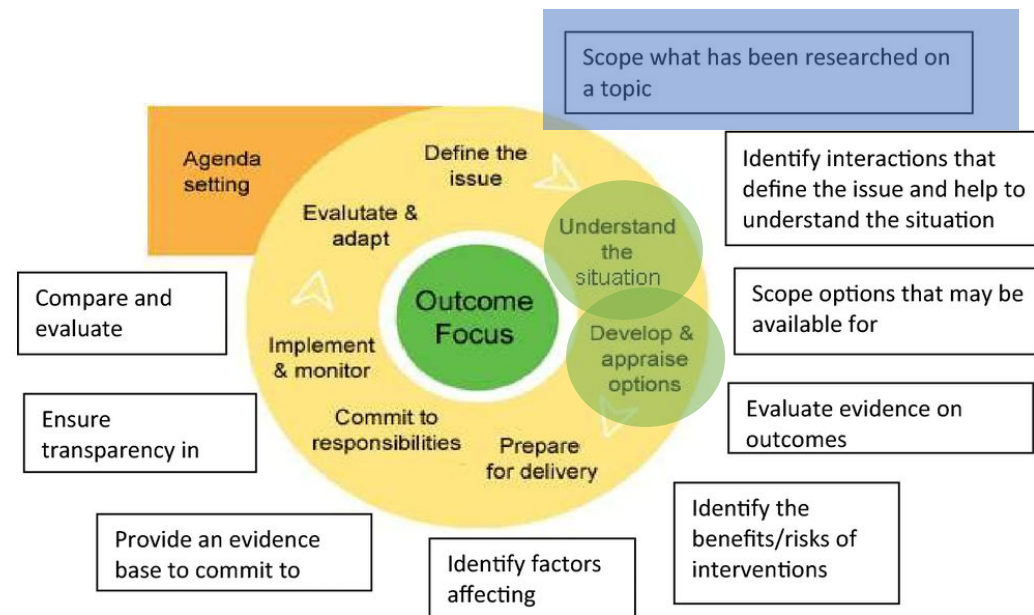
Defra, 2011. Defra's evidence investment strategy: 2010–2013 and beyond—2011 update.
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/defra-s-evidence-investment-strategy-2010-to-2013-and-beyond-2011-update>.
[Accessed 3 Sept 2026]

Lessons from engaging stakeholders in environmental evidence synthesis

An example: FRB + Mirova Investment Bank



What are the impacts of wind farms on biodiversity
in **France**?



The use of SR methods in the policy-making cycle, white boxes identify potential input of reviews

(adapted from [32, 33])

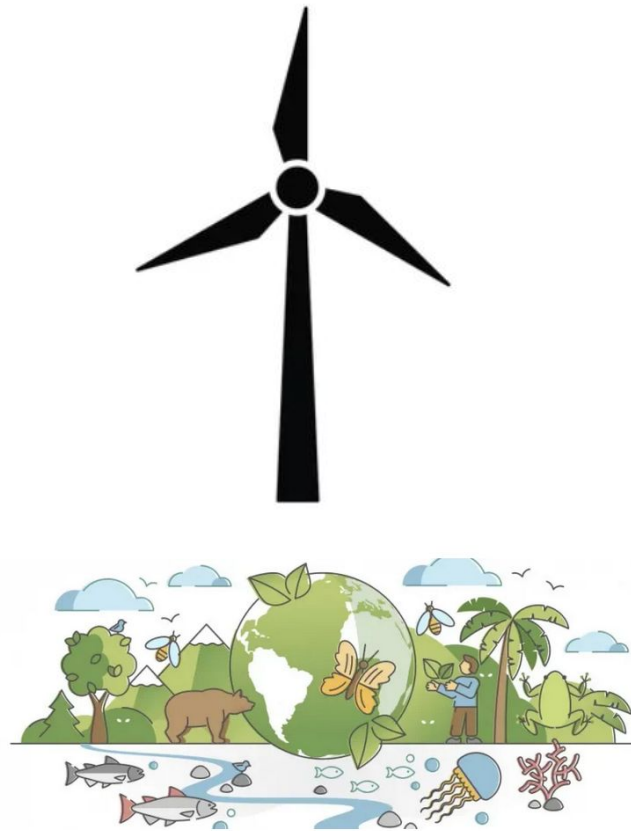
Collins et al 2019. *Environ Evid*. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13750-018-0144-0>



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Lessons from engaging stakeholders in environmental evidence synthesis

An example: FRB + Mirova Investment Bank



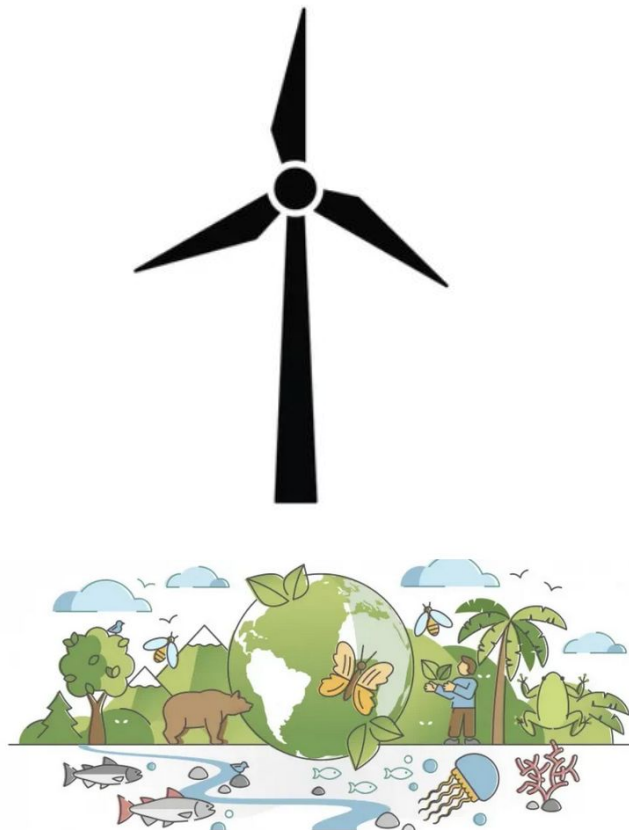
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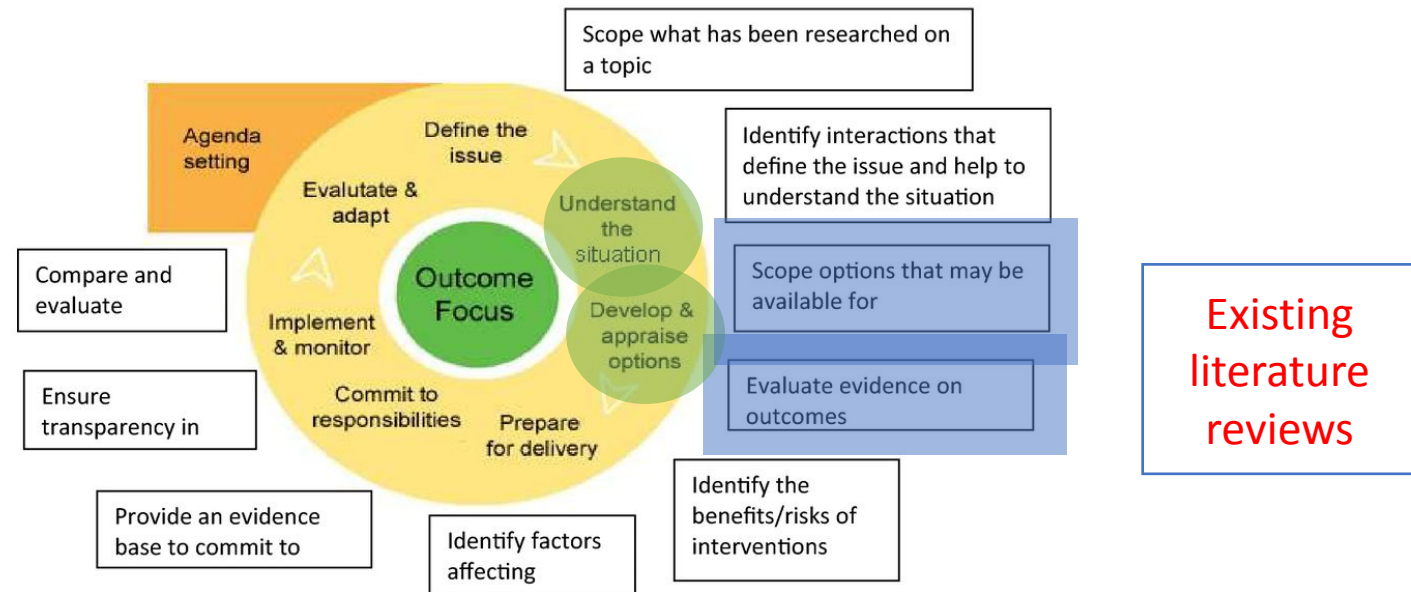
Timeline?

Lessons from engaging stakeholders in environmental evidence synthesis

An example: FRB + Mirova Investment Bank



What are the **impacts** of wind farms on biodiversity **in France**?



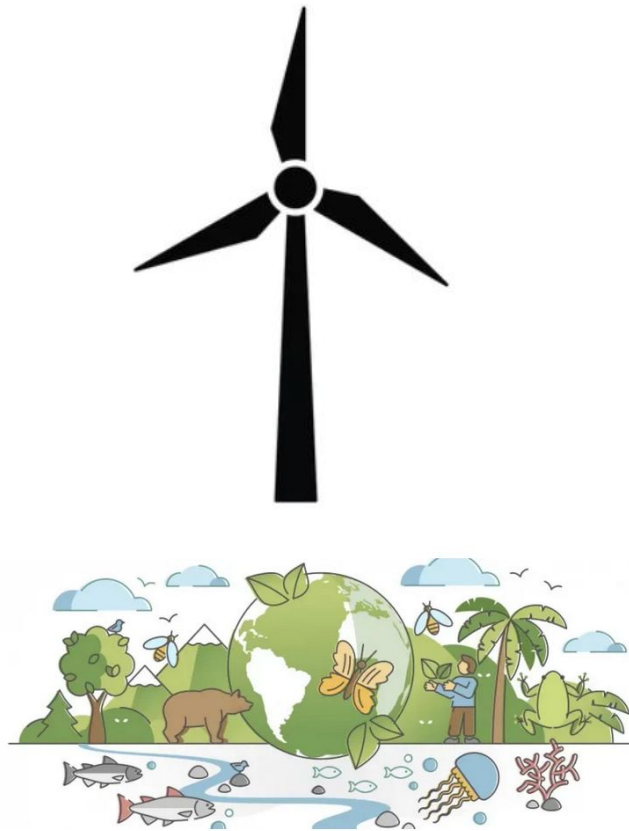
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Lessons from engaging stakeholders in environmental evidence synthesis

An example: FRB + Mirova Investment Bank



What is the effectiveness of existing solutions to reduce the impacts of wind farms on flying fauna?



Rapid Review

Title

How effective are existing solutions to mitigate impacts of onshore wind farms on flying vertebrates and invertebrates? A Rapid Review

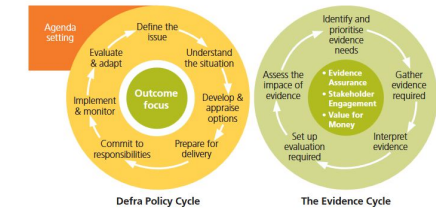
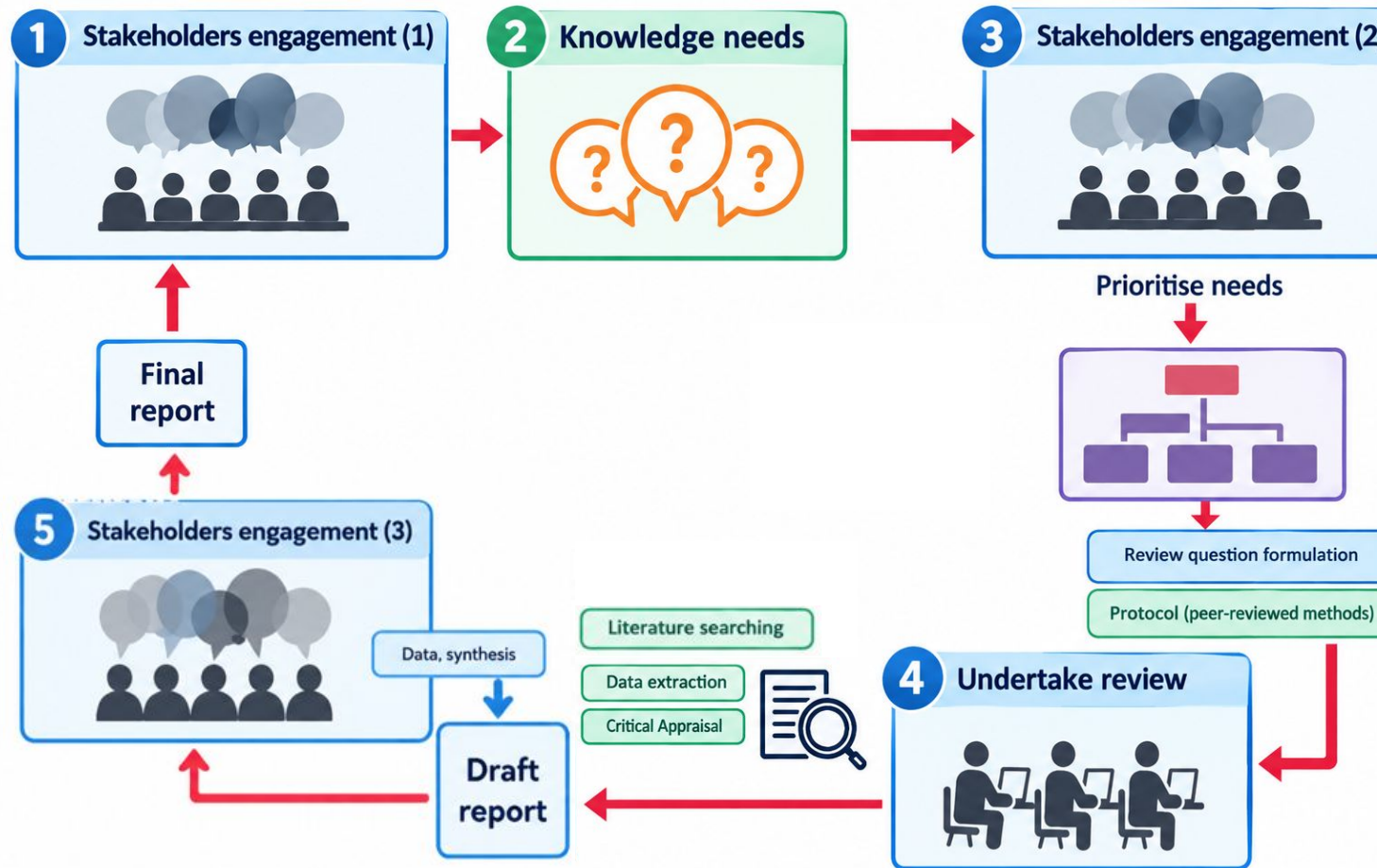
Citation:

Joseph Langridge, Louise Dupuis, Nicolas Hette-Tronquart, Hervé Jactel, Aurélien Besnard. How effective are existing solutions to mitigate impacts of onshore wind farms on flying vertebrates and invertebrates? A Rapid Review: a Rapid Review. PROCEED-23-00142 Available from: <https://www.proceedevidence.info/protocol/view-result?id=142>
<https://doi.org/10.57808/proceed.2023.15>



A framework for stakeholder engagement

A typical Evidence synthesis pathway



- 1 – Define the issue,
- 2 – Understand the situation
- 3 – Develop and appraise options + identify and prioritise evidence needs + prepare for delivery
- 4 – Gather evidence and undertake the review
- 5 – develop a communication strategy

A framework for stakeholder engagement

- (1) identification of stakeholders;
- (2) identification of policy- and practice-relevant topics;
- (3) framing and prioritisation of review questions;
- (4) establishment of the specific scope of a review;
- (5) a public review of a draft review protocol



Source: Land *et al.* 2017. *Environ Evid.* <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13750-017-0104-0>



Challenges and solutions

Key Challenges

1. Stakeholder engagement requires additional time and resources (Haddaway et al. 2017)

- *Resource and Time Constraints:* Limited time, budgets, and staff make sustained, high-level engagement difficult to maintain.

2. Ineffective Communication:

- Poor information flow and lack of transparency lead to distrust, resistance, and project delays.

3. The group of engaged stakeholders may not be balanced and representative

- Different dimensions of power in participatory processes can affect outcomes (Lécuyer et al. 2024)

Effective Solutions

- **Map and Prioritize Stakeholders:** Identify who needs to be involved and when, ensuring engagement efforts match clear project relevance (Haddaway et al. 2017)
- **Implement Transparent Communication:** Set regular communication touchpoints and share both challenges and successes openly to build long-term trust.
- **Tools:** Use centralized registers and collaborative platforms to capture structured feedback and ensure equitable participation (Haddaway et al. 2017)

Source: Lécuyer et al. 2024. *People and Nature*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/pan3.10672>
Haddaway et al. 2017. *Environ Evid*. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13750-017-0089-8>



MESSAGES CLÉS

- 1 | Understand your stakeholders' needs and roles
- 2 | Outline the benefits
- 3 | Develop a framework that works for both groups
- 4 | Anticipate the challenges, and provide solutions